```
    Layout = “/Pages/Shared/_Layout.cshtml”;
}
```

When you use the first approach to set the layout by name, the framework searches a number of predefined locations for a file with the matching name and a preconfigured extension, which is .cshtml by default. The folder containing the calling page is searched first, and if applicable, all folders in the hierarchy up to the root Pages folder will be searched. Finally, two further locations are searched: \Pages\Shared and \Views\Shared. The latter of these is a legacy of applications built using the MVC framework itself. If you placed the calling page in \Pages\Admin\DestinationsOrders, for example, the search locations will be as follows:

- \Pages\Admin\DestinationsOrders\ _Layout.cshtml
- \Pages\Admin\ _Layout.cshtml
- \Pages_Layout.cshtml
- \Pages\Shared\ _Layout.cshtml
- \Views\Shared\ _Layout.cshtml

Setting the layout on a page-by-page basis is not a very efficient approach if you want to assign the same layout to multiple pages for the same reason that you use a layout in the first place: updating it in multiple locations becomes a chore. To solve this problem, you can use a ViewStart file. This is a special Razor file named _ViewStart.cshtml, which you will find an example of located in the Pages folder. This file usually consists of a code block only, although it can contain markup too. The code within the ViewStart file is executed before any page that it affects, which is any Razor page in the same folder and all subfolders. Figure 3.3 shows the order of execution as a request comes in. First is the ViewStart file, then the content page, followed by any code in the layout file.